

Wilhelmina Duskmere

Character Dossier

Competitive about everything fishmonger of the Emerald Court of Ardenne

Overview

Wilhelmina Duskmere is a fishmonger living in the Emerald Court of Ardenne. Wilhelmina is 75 years old, originally from New Aster, and is known around the Mirror Gallery as competitive about everything. In conversation Wilhelmina swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Background

Wilhelmina arrived in the Emerald Court of Ardenne 8 years ago after leaving New Aster under circumstances Wilhelmina describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for House Ardenne; the second was the one that stuck. Today Wilhelmina works as a fishmonger near the royal mews and is paid, when paid at all, in crowns.

Wilhelmina learned the trade from Petra Stillwater, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Wilhelmina's life is with Jorah Lindqvist, over a matter neither will explain. The person Wilhelmina trusts most is Lysander Zimmerling.

Current goal: to teach one apprentice who actually listens. Greatest fear: losing their sense of smell.

Personality and speech

Temperament: competitive about everything.

Speech pattern: Wilhelmina swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Tells: when lying, Wilhelmina mentions Radish the cat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Wilhelmina Duskmere
<i>Role</i>	fishmonger
<i>Home</i>	the Emerald Court of Ardenne
<i>Hometown</i>	New Aster
<i>Age</i>	75
<i>Favourite dish</i>	twice-cooked sesame brittle
<i>Pet</i>	Radish, a cat
<i>Lucky number</i>	469

<i>Workshop password</i>	tide-saffron
<i>Mentor</i>	Petra Stillwater
<i>Rival</i>	Jorah Lindqvist
<i>Closest friend</i>	Lysander Zimmerling

Secret

Wilhelmina owes Jorah Lindqvist a debt of 156 crowns that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Wilhelmina: I am the fishmonger. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Wilhelmina: Twice-cooked sesame brittle. Do not tell Jorah I said so.

Visitor: Is Radish yours?

Wilhelmina: Radish belongs to nobody. Radish tolerates me. Lucky number is 469, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 28

Wilhelmina won 16 crowns on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on supper. Cassius came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Chancery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 2, autumn of year 28

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the Chancery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina found a bundle of letters half-buried near the Chancery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a glass float from the Chancery to the Mirror Gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 3, winter of year 28

Wilhelmina found a cracked compass half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the hand bell indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt. Wilhelmina found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, spring of year 28

A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the quarantine reached the lower kitchens. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the lower kitchens: 32 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short.

Entry 5, summer of year 29

At the Mirror Gallery, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a hand bell from the Mirror Gallery to the Chancery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the Mirror Gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sable came by asking about who really won the regatta. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, winter of year 29

Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Chancery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Noor came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the copper pipe indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 7, spring of year 29

Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Sunken Garden: 83 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. House Ardenne sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the hand bell indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 8, summer of year 29

Wilhelmina repaired the spool of wire at the Mirror Gallery for Imogen, who paid in 77 crowns and a long story about the tax on doors. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the Mirror Gallery, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Sable came by asking about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Mirror Gallery: 88 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short.

Entry 9, winter of year 30

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 10, winter of year 30

Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Sunken Garden, and watched the lights come on. Farida came by asking about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wilhelmina repaired the copper pipe at the royal mews for Qadira, who paid in 41 crowns and a long story about the quarantine. Kenji came by asking about the quarantine. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 11, spring of year 30

Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Chancery, and watched the lights come on. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Chancery, and watched the lights come on. Wilhelmina won 64 crowns on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 12, spring of year 30

A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the Sunken Garden; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the Sunken Garden; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote

three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Rurik came by asking about the quarantine. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 13, winter of year 31

Wilhelmina found a copper pipe half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wilhelmina won 69 crowns on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the royal mews, and watched the lights come on. Wilhelmina won 8 crowns on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 14, autumn of year 31

Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the lower kitchens, and watched the lights come on. Tiberius came by asking about the comet. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the Sunken Garden. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 15, winter of year 31

Wilhelmina repaired the wax seal at the Mirror Gallery for Orsolya, who paid in 64 crowns and a long story about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Chancery, and watched the lights come on. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wilhelmina found a cracked compass half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 16, spring of year 31

Wilhelmina won 65 crowns on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the census. At the Chancery, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks.

Entry 17, autumn of year 31

Wilhelmina won 57 crowns on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on supper. Wilhelmina found a sextant half-buried near the lower kitchens and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wilhelmina found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the lower kitchens and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the lower kitchens; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 18, winter of year 31

At the Sunken Garden, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real cracked compass from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 19, winter of year 31

Wilhelmina repaired the cracked compass at the Mirror Gallery for Lysander, who paid in 12 crowns and a long story about who really won the regatta. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Sunken Garden, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 20, autumn of year 31

Wilhelmina found a bundle of letters half-buried near the Sunken Garden and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. House Ardenne sent a notice about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 21, summer of year 31

Wilhelmina repaired the tin whistle at the Mirror Gallery for Mara, who paid in 54 crowns and a long story about the tax on doors. Wilhelmina found a bolt of linen half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wilhelmina found a ledger half-buried near the Mirror Gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. House Ardenne sent a notice about the tax on doors. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the Mirror Gallery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 22, summer of year 31

Wilhelmina repaired the bundle of letters at the Mirror Gallery for Fenwick, who paid in 49 crowns and a long story about the price of lamp oil. At the Mirror Gallery, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the Mirror Gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 23, summer of year 31

A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wilhelmina won 77 crowns on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. Wilhelmina repaired the signal flag at the Chancery for Noor, who paid in 54 crowns and a long story about the tax on doors. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the Chancery to the Sunken Garden without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 24, autumn of year 31

Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. House Ardenne sent a notice about the census. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the lower kitchens; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the lower kitchens: 5 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short.

Entry 25, spring of year 32

Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Mirror Gallery, and watched the lights come on. Wilhelmina won 32 crowns on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the royal mews, Wilhelmina taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 26, spring of year 32

Wilhelmina won 24 crowns on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. House Ardenne sent a notice about the quarantine. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. House Ardenne sent a notice about the comet. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 27, autumn of year 32

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kenji came by asking about the quarantine. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Lysander came by asking about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the lower kitchens: 62 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 28, summer of year 32

Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina has a suspect and is probably right. Wilhelmina repaired the bundle of letters at the lower kitchens for Katarina, who paid in 46 crowns and a long story about the tariff on salt. Wilhelmina won 81 crowns on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Wilhelmina and a neighbour outside the lower kitchens; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Calloway came by asking about the comet. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead.